



Plums in the Moonlight

By Anna Kirschberg

Illustrated by James Keiaho



Book Summary

This title looks at a simple fantasy themed story about Pip and Pat in a medieval forest one day. They are lost and find help from Og. The text will introduce the reader to new consonant blends. Detailed and vibrant illustrations depict and help the text explain some basic story information about each page.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 4 progression and focuses on teaching blending and segmentation of adjacent consonant blends.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with **'tricky words'** or **'Common Exception Words'** (CEWs). Common Exception Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 4 - Blends

CVCC (nd mp nt, nk ft st, lt lk sk)	CCVC (fr br, cr tr, gr dr pr)
CCVC (pl bl gl, sl fl cl, st sp sn, sm sw)	CCVCC (short vowel)
CVCC CCVC CCVCC (long vowel)	CCCVC CVCCC

Tricky Words:

the, I, to, of, is, into, go, his, we, here, there, me, you, he, they, are, said, out, come, have, some, glass, asks

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sounds;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children's prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

Describe the setting on the front cover illustration.

Describe the character on the front cover.

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud the featured common exception words from each phase, from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. The main characters are Pip and Pat. Discuss the setting and scene shown in the pictures. What is happening here?

Pages 4 and 5 – In the illustrations on these pages, the girls see a glint of green and encounter Og. Describe Og.

Pages 6 and 7 – Here, Og offers the girls something that will help them find their way out from the forest if they are lost. What is it?

Page 8 – The final page ends with the girls thanking Og.

Children can now read the book independently.

At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the story that use some of the new consonant blends being taught in Phase 4. Identify as many new blends as you can in words in the text. For example, 'pl' in 'plum', and 'bl' in 'blink', and 'gl' in 'glint'.

Revisit the common exception words in the text. Notice the use of any different types of punctuation. Discuss these.

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the different types of consonant blends being used in the text of the story.